The Practice of Dharma Conduct in Brief

Toh 1278 · Derge Tengyur
ཆོས་སྤྱོད་མདོར་བསྡུ་པའི་ཏྲ

The Practice of Dharma Conduct in Brief, in Tibetan Chöchö Dordü pé Jawa, is a short ritual manual for the daily practice of a yogin of the Hevajra tantra; its Sanskrit title is not preserved in the Tibetan, and no author is named. Beginning at dawn, when the practitioner is awakened by the goddesses of the four immeasurables, it sets out in order the preparation and blessing of the offering maṇḍala, the placing of flowers for Hevajra and his eight surrounding goddesses, the protection of body, speech and mind, the invitation of the guru and the deities, and the outer, inner and secret offerings. It closes with confession, rejoicing, refuge, dedication, the offering of oneself, praise and the request for forbearance, the hundred-syllable mantra, aspiration prayers, and the request for the deities to depart. It is Toh 1278 in the Tengyur, where it belongs among the ritual and practice texts attached to the commentaries on the tantras, in the Hevajra cycle.

Herein is The Practice of Dharma Conduct in Brief.

Homage to glorious Hevajra.

The yogin who enters this path first sleeps within the state of innate bliss. Then, at dawn, roused by the four goddesses of the immeasurables with the songs of the immeasurables, he rises, bathes, and stays indoors. With the five kinds of clear nectar and with a clear mind he carefully prepares the maṇḍala and smears it, and by saying vajra rekhe hūṃ he blesses the ground. Then he places a single flower in the center of the maṇḍala. He imagines the protective pegs as wrathful deities above and daggers below, as one, and so protects it. Placing a flower on his own head, he protects his body, and then he washes his hands.

With oṃ de ba pi cu vajra hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svā hā he places a flower in the center, and so generates the principal deity as father and mother in union. In the east he places a flower with go rī na maḥ. Likewise, in the south, west and north, and in the intermediate directions southeast, southwest, northwest and northeast, in order, he lays out flowers with co bo rī na maḥ, be tā lī na maḥ, ghasma rī na maḥ, pukka sī na maḥ, śa ba rī na maḥ, caṇḍalī na maḥ and ḍo mbi nī na maḥ, and there he generates each goddess by mere devotion.

Having arranged the offerings in order and properly displayed the painted images and so forth, he sits on a comfortable seat or the like. Imagining himself as his chosen deity, at his heart he visualizes a lotus arising from paṃ and, upon a sun arising from raṃ, a blue hūṃ. With his body he holds the vajra and bell. With his speech he recites oṃ he vajra a dhi śtha ṇa rakśa rakśa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svā hā. With his mind he imagines that light radiates from the hūṃ, and that everything becomes a vajra ground, net, fence and tent.

Joining the mantra above, rakṣa and the rest, to oṃ he vajra, he makes his whole body into the form of a vajra through visualization. By joining ji hva and the rest to oṃ vajra vajra, he imagines his speech as vajra. By reciting oṃ he vajra yo ga rakṣa rakṣa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svā hā, he imagines that his mind has taken the form of a vajra: this is the protection of the mind.

Then, focusing on all the offerings and reciting oṃ vajra pu ṣbe āḥ hūṃ and the rest for each, he blesses the flowers, incense, lamps, scented water and food offerings as holding their respective substances. For the water for welcome he recites jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ svā hā, and for the water for the feet ri ti khaṃ svā hā. Having blessed them by reciting these, he invites the deities of the assembly. With his body he holds the vajra and bell, and with his speech he says:

"You who are surrounded by the assembly of yoginīs,
indestructible vajra, granting whatever is wished,
having come in supreme delight,
please bestow your blessing."

With his mind he imagines that light radiates from the hūṃ on the lotus at his heart, and by that light he invites the guru and Hevajra together with his retinue. He offers them water for welcome, water for the feet and seats, and requests them to be seated upon the maṇḍala.

Then, first, directing his awareness to the space between the guru's eyebrows, he prostrates to the guru and makes offerings. Then, in his mind, he touches the crown of his head to the feet of the principal deity and imagines that the misdeeds of body, speech and mind are purified. With his body he prostrates; with his speech he recites the words, and so prostrates.

Then comes the presentation of offerings. First, the human offerings: if there are substances arranged in order, he presents those; if not, he emanates the goddesses of the outer offerings from his own heart and presents them. With his speech he says:

"This flower, a fine divine substance,
born from water and from dry land,
I offer with supreme respect:
please accept it as you please. oṃ hūṃ
This incense, a fine divine substance,
blended with what is innate,
I offer with supreme respect:
please accept it as you please. oṃ hūṃ
This lamp, auspicious, utterly vanquishing the seizing spirits,
virtuous and dispelling darkness,
I offer with supreme respect:
please accept it as you please. oṃ hūṃ
This fragrant water, water of the gods,
delightful water of the forest groves,
I offer with supreme respect:
please accept it as you please. oṃ hūṃ
These food offerings, the fare of mantra,
the delightful essence of medicines,
I offer with supreme respect:
please accept them as you please."

With oṃ sarba ta thā ga ta nai vi dye pū ja me gha sa mu dra spha ra ṇa sa ma ye hūṃ he should present the offerings.

Now the inner offering: from his own heart he emanates eight goddesses: Gaurī holding white bodhicitta, Caurī holding red bodhicitta, Vetālī holding urine, Ghasmarī holding the five meats, and Caṇḍālī beating a small hand drum. Having emanated them, he makes offering.

The secret offering: from his own heart he emanates the goddess Ḍombinī, dissolves her inseparably into the mother, Nairātmyā, and makes offering. At that time he says this with his speech:

"Gaurī holds the hare-bearer (the moon);
Caurī holds the sun;
Vaitālī holds vajra water;
Ghasmarī holds medicine;
Pukkasī holds a sandalwood tree;
Śavarī holds honey;
Caṇḍālī beats the sound of the hand drum;

Ḍombinī embraces the neck.
With great passion, deeply attached,
may she act as she would with a man.
Outer, inner and secret:
with these three I offer to the principal deity.
oṃ sarba ta thā ga ta a nutta ra pū ja me gha sa mu dra spha ra ṇa sa ma ye hūṃ svā hā hāṃ"

Then comes the confession of misdeeds:

"Whatever misdeeds I have committed,
or rejoiced in, or caused to be done,
here before the perfect buddhas
I confess each one, all without exception.
In the buddhas and the bodhisattvas,
in the noble pratyekabuddhas and śrāvakas,
and in the hosts of ordinary beings,
I rejoice with respect.
In the perfect Buddha, supreme among humans,
in the true Dharma he taught,
and in the Saṅgha of bodhisattvas,
I take refuge until awakening.
Perfecting all the perfections,
generosity and the rest,
I shall truly follow the path
of the unsurpassed Vajra Vehicle.
Through all this virtue of mine,
having fully perfected unsurpassed awakening,
for the welfare and benefit of all sentient beings
I shall establish them in nonabiding nirvāṇa.
May all this virtue of mine
become fully complete,
and, in common with all sentient beings,
may it fully ripen and be perfected."

Having said this, offer your own body to the buddhas and bodhisattvas and to the assembly of deities of glorious Hevajra together with the retinue, saying: "Please accept me at all times and in every way. Protectors endowed with great compassion, please grant the accomplishment of the great commitment

(samaya)."

Then, having taken the vows, praise them with the Twenty Verses of Praise, and request their forbearance with the verse beginning "Whatever I, with deluded mind ..." and so on.

Having recited the hundred-syllable mantra three times, make the aspiration:

"Born into the family and holding the commitments,
teaching Hevajra, free of madness,
respectful to the guru and endowed with compassion,
may I be so in birth after birth.
My hands ringing the vajra and bell,
reciting the profound Dharma,
sharing the consort's fluid as common food,
may I be so in birth after birth."

Then comes the request to depart:

"oṃ You have accomplished every aim of sentient beings;
grant the accomplishments that accord with them.
Though you return to the buddha realm,
please come again."

Having said this, request them to depart with he vajra maṇḍala muḥ.

The Practice in Brief is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The inner offering announces eight goddesses but names only five; the text is translated as it stands. In "the water for the feet" the text's zhabs ba sil is taken as zhabs bsil. "Blended with what is innate" renders lhan cig skyes dang sbyar ba literally; it may simply mean incense compounded of mixed ingredients.
• The line rendered "teaching Hevajra, free of madness" reads smyo med kyi yi rdo rje ston, taken as smyo med kye yi rdo rje ston; it is uncertain. Spos mo and ri khrod ma are taken as the Hevajra goddesses Pukkasī and Śavarī, and g.yung mo as Ḍombinī, matching the order of the eight goddesses in the first part of the text.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human

translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.